Neilly H. Tan

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I am a sociotechnical scholar and design researcher studying the ethical, social, and political implications of personal data and technology systems. My work focuses on multi-stakeholder settings involving Internet of Things (IoT) and artificial intelligence (AI) sensors to address privacy and surveillance vulnerabilities. In human-computer interaction (HCI), I employ qualitative, participatory, and design-based approaches to explore, evaluate, and enact techniques that support advocacy and agency in everyday computing technologies.

Education

2027	**Ph.D. at University of Washington, Human-Centered Design & Engineering (expected)** Committee: Sean A. Munson (co-chair), Audrey Desjardins (co-chair), Richmond Y. Wong, Lindah Kotut.
2022	**M.S. at University of Washington, Human-Centered Design & Engineering**
2018	**B.Sc. at Brown University, Cognitive Science (focus in Human-Computer Interaction)** Extended coursework in Visual Art. Advised by Jeff Huang.
2018	**Coursework at Rhode Island School of Design, Graphic & Industrial Design** Cross-registered at Brown University.

Awards & Honors

2026-27	**Martha H. Duggan Fellowship in Caring Labor, UW Harry Bridges Center for Labor Studies** — $10,000
2021-26	**National Science Foundation Graduate Research Fellowship (GRF)** — $37,000 annual stipend, tuition, and health insurance for 3 years ($159,000 total)
2023	**HCDE Doctoral Grant Award** — "Contextualizing Information Seeking, Authenticity, and Safety Practices on Intimate Platforms," co-authored with Liang
2022	**UW Graduate Student Conference Presentation Award**
2021	**UW HCDE Graduate Student Association Team Award**
2020	**UW Resilience Lab Seed Grant** — $2,500, co-authored with Cunningham, Pistorus, Beers, & Lustig
2018	**LINK Award, Brown University** — $2,500
2016, 2017	**Karen T. Romer Undergraduate Research & Teaching Award (UTRA), Brown University** — $2,500, two-time recipient

Conference & Journal Publications (Refereed)[1]

** indicates equal contribution.*

P1. **Tan, N.H.**, Desjardins, A., Munson, S.A. 2027. ***Everyday Layers of Resistance to Smart Camera Surveillance.***
— IN PREPARATION.

P2. Wang, S., **Tan, N.H.**, & Munson, S.A. 2026. ***Negotiating Autonomy, Control, and Privacy in Always-On Home IoT Technology-Mediated Care Relationships with Older Adults.***
Proc. ACM Interact. Mob. Wearable Ubiquitous Technol. (Ubicomp '26). — PDF. ONLINE.

P3. Benabdallah, G., Alexander, A.*, Ghosh, S*., Glogovac-Smith, C.*, Jacoby, L.*, Lustig, C.*, Nguyen, A.*, Parkhurst, A.*, Reyes, K.*, **Tan, N.H.*** and Wolcher, E.* 2022. ***Slanted Speculations: Material Encounters with Algorithmic Bias.***
Proc. ACM Conf. on Designing Interactive Systems (DIS '22). — ONLINE.

1 Top-tier publication venues in HCI research include the ACM conferences CHI, CSCW, DIS, and Ubicomp. In computer science and HCI research, students are typically named first, and faculty/senior authors are named last.

P4. **Tan, N.H.**, Y. Wong, R., Desjardins, A., A. Munson, S., & Pierce, J. 2022. ***Monitoring Pets, Deterring Intruders, and Casually Spying on Neighbors: Everyday Uses of Smart Home Cameras.***
Proc. ACM Conf. on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '22). — PDF. ONLINE.

P5. **Tan, N.H.**, Kinnee, B., Langseth, D., Munson, S., & Desjardins, A. 2022. ***Critical-Playful Speculations with Cameras in the Home.***
Proc. ACM Conf. on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '22). — PDF. ONLINE.

P6. Wallace, S., Papoutsaki, A., **Tan, N.H.**, Guo, H., & Huang, J. 2021. ***Case Studies on the Motivation and Performance of Contributors who Verify and Maintain In-Flux Tabular Datasets.***
Proc. ACM Hum.-Comput. Interact. 5, CSCW2, Article 448 (Oct. '21). — PDF. ONLINE.

P7. **Tan, N.A.H.***, Sha, H.*, Celen, E.*, Tran, P., Wang, K., Cheung, G., Hinch, P. and Huang, J., 2018. ***Rewind: Automatically Reconstructing Everyday Memories with First-Person Perspectives.*** Proc. ACM Interact. Mob. Wearable Ubiquitous Technol. 2, 4, Article 191 (Dec. '18). — PDF. ONLINE.

Workshop Papers & Proposals

W1. Wong, R., **Tan, N.H.**, Gray, N., Valdez, J., & Pierce, J. ***Material Experiments and Playful Disruptions: Interrogating Boundaries, Meanings, and Aesthetics of the Smart Camera.*** 4S, Making and Doing Session.
— ONLINE.

W2. Liang, C.A., Tseng, E., Pendse, S., Lee, C., Allison, K.R., **Tan, N.H.**, Wang, R., To, A., & Zhang, A. 2021. ***Subtle CSCW Traits: Tensions Around Identity Formation and Online Activism in the Asian Diaspora.*** CSCW '21 Companion. — ONLINE.

Teaching

Courses

University of Washington, Seattle, WA.

Teaching Assistant: Foundations of HCDE (HCDE 302), Prof. Arpita B.	Fall 2026
Teaching Assistant: Interaction Design & Prototyping (HCDE 536), Prof. Paula Te.	Spring 2026
Teaching Assistant: Research Methods (INFO 300), Prof. Spencer Williams.	Summer 2025
Teaching Assistant: Slow Interaction Design (HCDE 418), Prof. Tyler Fox.	Spring 2025
Teaching Assistant: Interaction Design for Everyday Reflection (HCDE 418), Prof. Jennifer Turns.	Spring 2021

Brown University, Providence, RI.

Teaching Assistant: Statistical Methods (CLPS 0900), Prof. Kathryn Spoehr.	Fall 2018
Head Teaching Assistant: User Interfaces & User Experiences (CSCI 1300), Prof. Jeff Huang.	Fall 2017
Teaching Assistant: User Interfaces & User Experiences (CSCI 1300), Prof. Jeff Huang.	Fall 2016
Design Software Instructor, Brown University Computer Education	Spring 2016–18

Directed Research Groups

I have led the following "Directed Research Groups" (DRGs) across HCDE and School of Art + Art History + Design (DESIGN) at the University of Washington. DRGs are small, project-based courses offered for 2-3 credits.

Instructor: Careful Data Infrastructures in Home Childcare Work DRG (HCDE 496/596). — Win–Spr 2025
3 students · Organized with Daniela Rosner, Sean Munson.

Co-instructor (w/ Shengzhi Wang): Older Adults and IoT DRG (HCDE 496/596). — Spring 2022
4 students · Organized with Sean Munson.

Co-instructor (w/ Richmond Wong): Non-Primary IoT Users DRG (DESIGN 596). — Winter 2021
2 students · Organized with James Pierce.

Instructor: Discursive Design Inquiry with Home Cameras DRG (HCDE 496/596). — Fall 2020
4 students · Organized with Audrey Desjardins, Sean Munson.

Invited Lectures

Panelist on Qualitative Research: Design Field Studies (DESIGN 481)	Fall 2025
Guest Critique: Design Field Studies (DESIGN 481)	Fall 2025
Guest Critique: Design Field Studies (DESIGN 481)	Spring 2023
Panelist on Interview Methods: Qualitative Research Methods (HCDE 519)	Winter 2022
Presentation on Sousveillance Theory Lineage: Theoretical Foundations (HCDE 542)	Spring 2021

Presentations & Workshops

Invited Talks

2026 ***Caring Labor Futures in the Home.*** Reclaiming the Futures of Work panel, Society for Social Studies of Science (4S). Toronto, Canada.

2025 ***Subjectivities of/within Surveillance*** (with Claire Weizenegger). The Rise of Research Security panel, 4S. Seattle, WA.

2022 ***Exploring, Enacting, Questioning: Critical and Design Research Perspectives on Sensing Technologies in the Home.*** ACM CHI Manila. Virtual.

Invited Workshop Participation

2026 Workers Confront Racial Capitalism, UW Harry Bridges Center for Labor Studies Summer School

2025 Consortium for the Science of Sociotechnical Systems (CSST) Summer Research Institute

2023 Back-to-Back to Labor Workshop, ACM CSCW Conference

2023 Human-Computer Interaction Consortium (HCIC)

2023 UW DUB (Design, Use, Build) Doctoral Colloquium

2023 The Future of HCI-Policy Collaboration, ACM CHI Conference

2021 Human-Data Interaction Through Design, ACM CHI Conference

2021 Alternative Care Translations: Using Care as a Lens for Speculative Fabulating Workshop

Posters

2026 ***Building Power in Surveilled Workspaces.*** UW Harry Bridges Center for Labor Studies Awards Celebration.

Public Scholarship

2026 Interviewed for Vox article, ***Your Ring camera isn't stopping crime. But it might be making you paranoid.*** Allie Volpe, July 2026. — ONLINE.

2026 Co-designed a zine with nannies on workplace surveillance, ***Creating Connected Caregiving.*** — IN PREPARATION.

Academic Service

Department & University Leadership

2026 Student Co-organizer, HCDE Distinguished Lecture Keynote Speaker

2021-25 Ph.D. Mentor, HCDE Peer Mentorship Program

2022-23 DUB Student Coordinator

2021-22 DUB Seminar Coordinator

2022 HCDE Ph.D. Grant Reviewer

2020 Ph.D. Representative, HCDE Graduate Student Association

2020 Student Organizer, HCDE Ph.D. Visit Days

2015-16 Peer Academic Advisor, Brown University Meiklejohn Program

2014-15 Hope High School Math Tutor, Brown University Algebra-in-Motion

Workshop Organization

2021 ACM CSCW. Co-organizer, "Subtle CSCW Traits: Identity Formation and Online Activism in the Asian Diaspora."

Program Committee Membership

2023 ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability & Transparency (FACCT)

Reviewing

2026, 2025 ACM Conference on Designing Interactive Systems (DIS)

2021–25 (4×)* ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)
**Special Recognition for Outstanding Reviews: 2021, 2022*

2024 ASIS&T Information Needs, Seeking and Use (SIG-USE) Symposium

Student Volunteer

2025 Society for Social Studies of Science (4S), Local Support Network

2019 ACM Ubicomp-ISWC, International Symposium on Wearable Computing

2016 Workshop on the Impact of Pen and Touch Technology in Education (WIPTTE)

Mentoring

2024-25 Priya Dhawka, HCDE Ph.D. Student
Cindy Te, Interaction Design Undergraduate

2022-23 Samuel So, HCDE Ph.D. Student

2022 Nathaniel Gray, M.S. Human-Computer Interaction + Design
Jason Valdez, M.S. Human-Computer Interaction + Design

2021-22 Shengzhi Wang, HCDE Ph.D. Student
Dana Langseth, HCDE M.S. Student

2021 Yuna Shin, Interaction Design Undergraduate
Joyce Lim, Interaction Design Undergraduate

Industry Experience

Meta, Menlo Park, CA May–Aug 2022
UX Research Intern, Data Infrastructure

- Spearheaded product research and direction on board-level Privacy & Security initiatives across Data Infrastructure through two studies: (1) Concept testing with 5 data engineers and 3 machine learning developers, and (2) Content analysis of ~300 employee experiences about privacy enhancing technologies.
- Collaborated with PMs, engineers, and designers horizontally across multiple teams and organizations.
- Results impacted product strategy with senior-level product and engineering managers.

Bolster (formerly TextUp), Providence, RI Jan–Aug 2019
UX Researcher and Designer

- Designed a secure cloud-based communication platform used by social workers and healthcare providers under HIPAA and FERPA constraints.

Affect Mental Health, Cambridge, MA May–Aug 2018
UI/UX Intern

- Led the UX design team in creating a mental healthcare startup's first resource website through user interviews, wireframing, and high-fidelity prototyping, with support from MIT and the Harvard Innovation Lab.